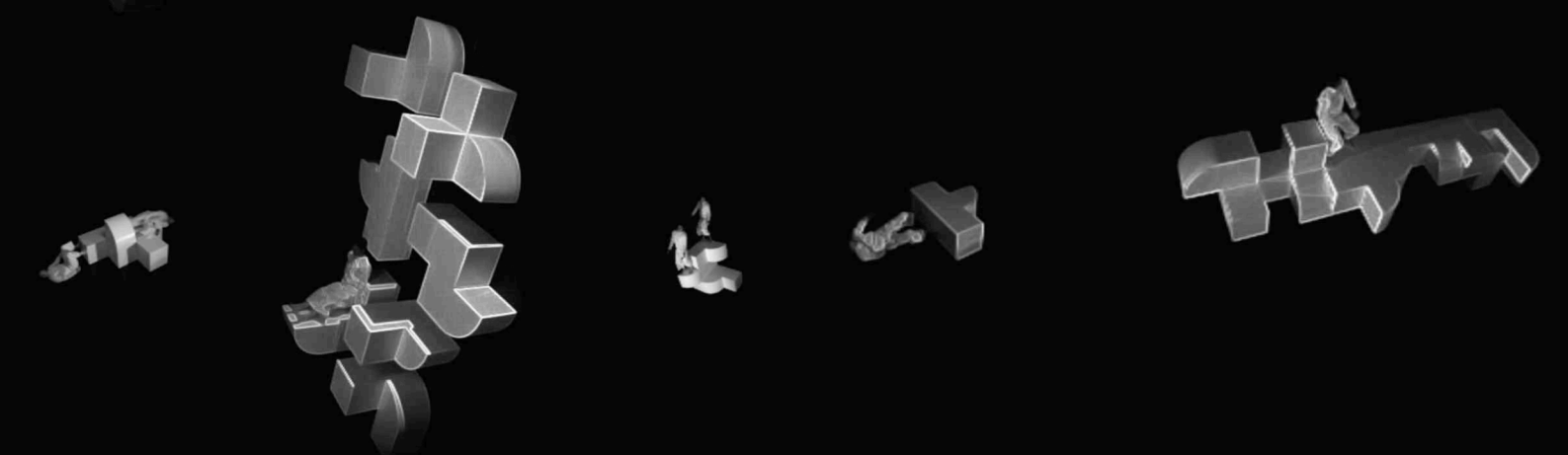




SOMA SONGS

Good Company Arts — Daniel Belton & Collaborators — 2005–2018

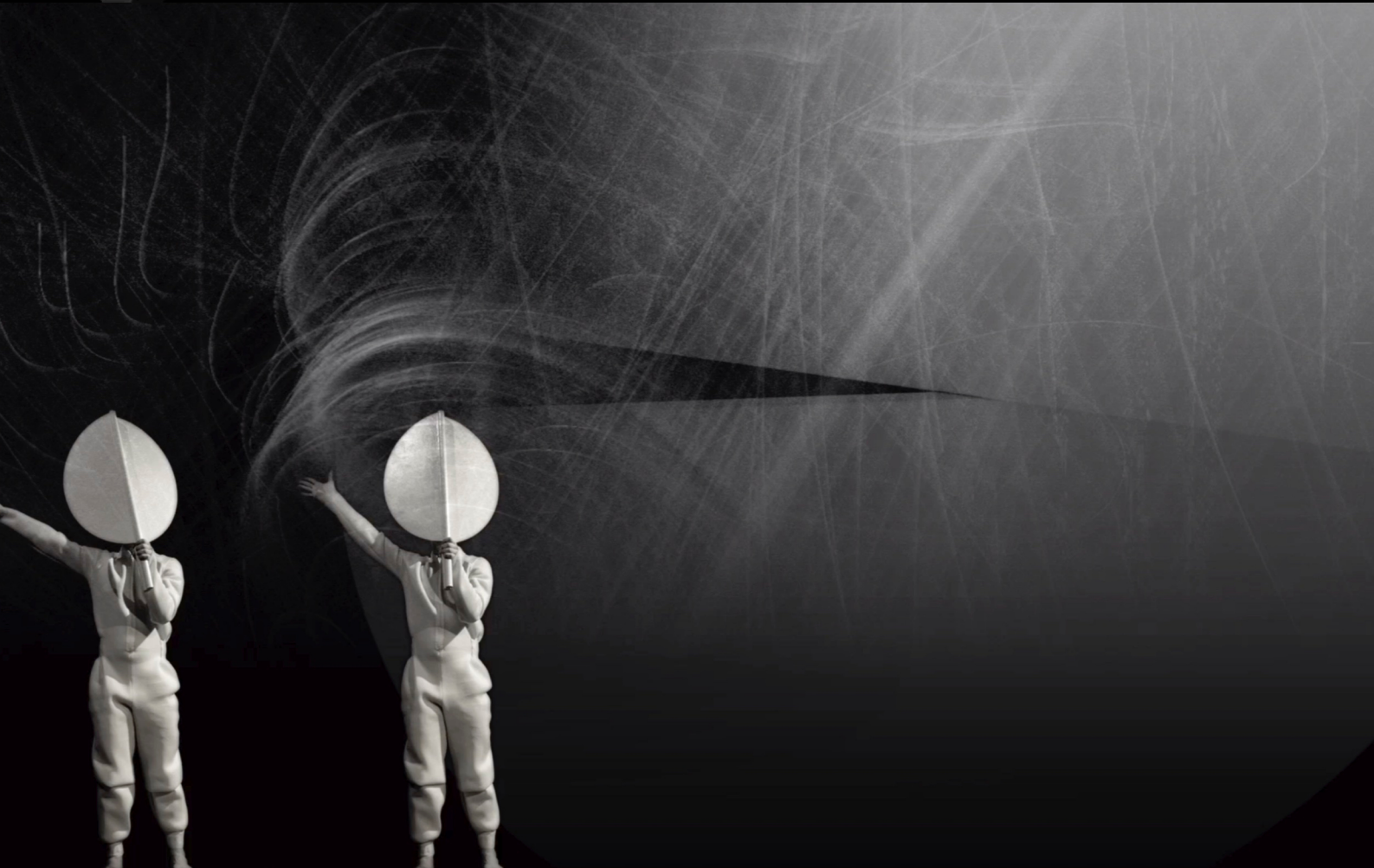
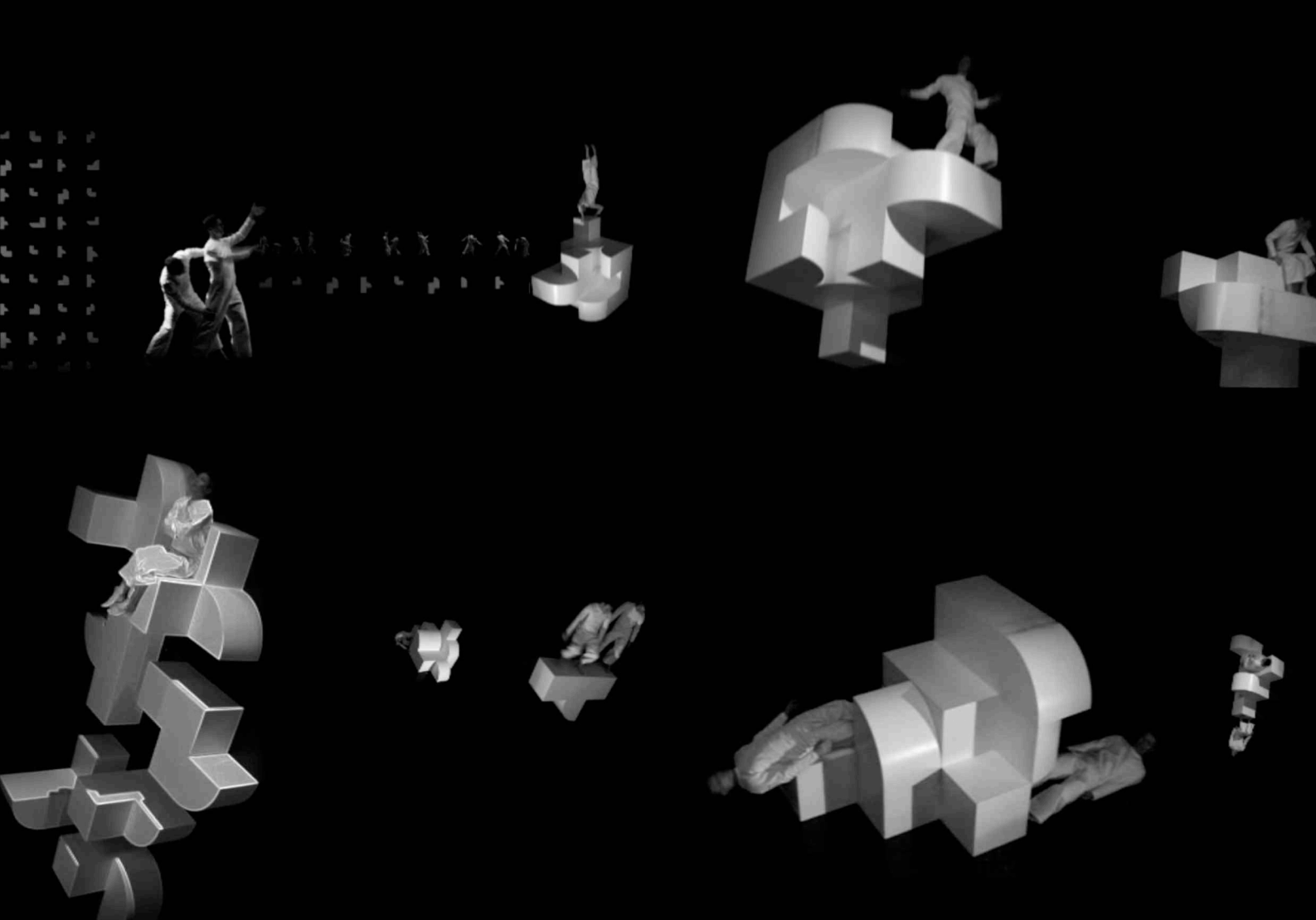
Soma Songs is a long-form digital cinema and live AV performance work developed by Daniel Belton and Good Company Arts over more than a decade. Originating as a tri-format projection mapping and sonic sculpture installation at Dunedin Public Art Gallery, Aotearoa New Zealand (2005), the work evolved through international touring to its major co-commission for DOKK1 at Aarhus Festuge, Denmark (2015) — Soma Songs Light More Light — realised with ten 21K projectors across the landmark media facade. The DOKK1 realisation was co-created with Henrik Elburn of xm:lab, Saarbrücken — whose technical direction, projection mapping expertise, and creative partnership were central to the work's realisation at architectural scale, in association with Creative New Zealand and ProShop Europe. Most recently presented as live AV sets at Tokyo Performing Arts Meeting (TPAM), Yokohama, Japan 2018.

The work traces the human body as architectural glyph — stone, rhythm, light, and digital form held in choreographic dialogue. Josef Belton appears in the original digital film as a performer, aged five — his body already part of the work that would, twenty years later, become the foundation of a father and son creative partnership.

"Light has a consciousness. Geometric forms affect us because there is consciousness in the form. We are on the edge of shadow when we engage in the architecture of light — spaces and forms come alive when given the pulse of human presence." — Daniel Belton, 2005

Recognised internationally across festivals in Spain, Italy, Germany, Czech Republic, Colombia, Argentina, Japan, and the UK, and finalist for the VideoDanza Barcelona Prize and ReelDance Awards Sydney. The work is featured in Daniel Belton's doctoral thesis *The Somatic Digital: Interspaces in Choreographing Media* (Massey University, under examination 2026) and in his peer-reviewed paper published in *EscenaUno* No. 24 (August 2026).

Project page: <https://www.goodcompanyarts.com/soma-songs>



ENCOUNTER

Good Company Arts — Daniel Belton & Collaborators — 2025–2027

Encounter is a digital cinema and live performance work in development by Daniel Belton and Good Company Arts, in cultural exchange between Aotearoa New Zealand and the Basque Country. Drawing on the sculptural philosophy of Basque artist Jorge Oteiza — his theory of emptying form to create a spiritually charged void — the work brings together choreography, virtual 3D sculpture, taonga pūoro, traditional Basque instruments, and bespoke hand-held Aistruments that bridge the analogue body and the digital scenographic environment.

Developed across two research stages (2025), Encounter brings together dance artists Amit Noy and Natalie Hona, composer Juan José Eslava Cabanellas, motion graphics artist Jac Grenfell, and taonga pūoro artists Ariana Tikao, Alistair Fraser and Ruby Solly, with the support of the Fundación Museo Jorge Oteiza and Creative New Zealand to Aotearoa.

The work has been invited to the Prague Quadrennial 2027 and to the Museo Jorge Oteiza, Basque Country, June 2027. Josef Belton joins the realisation team for these live presentations, bringing spatial design expertise, object making, Touch Designer and BNK-16 macropad technical knowledge to the work's next stage of development.

Project Pages: <https://www.goodcompanyarts.com/journal/good-company-arts-encounter>
<https://www.goodcompanyarts.com/journal/encounter-stage-2>

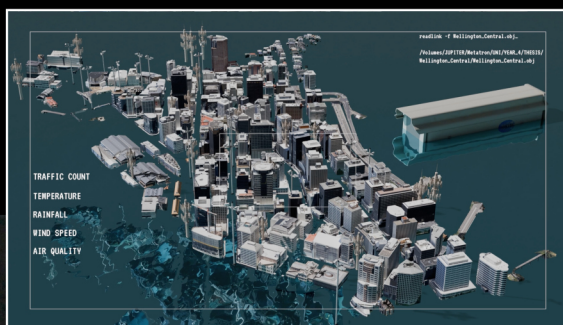


NEW SMART CITY

Josef Belton — 2025 Spatial Design Degree Honours Project (Massey University)

New Smart City is an intermedial artwork which responds to the digital twin of Wellington City. A digital twin is made to reveal, visualise, or summarise the huge amounts of data or information generated from a 'smart' physical entity. As Wellington city gradually implements its twin we are given an opportunity to reflect on the culture of digital twins and simulations and the relationship between physical spaces and their digital replicas. Digital space is not infinite, it takes physical material to construct and maintain, and efficiency and technified objectivity are ideals which tend to homogenise a variety of needs into a harmful majoritarian common good. Technological solutions position themselves as points of progression, but obscure their own processes of creation and eventual outcomes. Exploring this: Machine vision, journeys and processes of manufacturing and assembly, human interpretation, and a quantification of biological and ecological conditions inspire New Smart City's interactive works and multimedia scenographics.

To see more: <https://josefbelton.github.io/webbbsite/>



Your touch

Pre-concrete or pre-fibreglass sand

PIR motion sensor

Manipulation of physical projected environment

temporal manipulation of an animated Wellington city material study

